

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 3
 ♥ 9 8 7 2
 ♦ 8 6 5 3
 ♣ K 6

♠ K 7 4

♥ A J 10

♦ Q J 4

♣ Q J 10 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K 10

♣ A 9 8 2

West	North	East	South
			2NT

Pass 6NT

All Pass

6NT by South

[showcards N:S4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. South's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, North has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore West must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that West **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since West will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

South has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠10 and made the slam.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ 9 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ K Q 4

♠ K J 5

♥ Q 7 4

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A J 9 5



♠ 7 6 3

♥ K J 10

♦ K J 9 6

♣ 10 7 2

♠ A Q 4

♥ A 8 5

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ 8 6 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

If you play low, he **MIGHT** finesse the ♣J and again establish 3 ♣ winners. But South's correct play would be to put on dummy's ♣9, finessing West for the ♣10. This is because ♣ K 10 **or** ♣ Q 10 are twice as likely as ♣ K Q.

If he does play this way East will win the ♣10 and your ♣ K Q will get one more trick.

[showcards S:C3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠10; low cards from North and East, won by South with the ♠A.

South next plays the ♣3 and you must decide whether to split your ♣ K Q.

Play the ♣4.

If you split your Honors, playing the ♣Q perhaps, dummy's ♣A will take the trick and South will later play through your ♣K toward dummy's ♣ J 9 5. Played in this way he will establish 3 ♣ winners (which he needs for the contract).